

# *Introduction to Transformers*

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## *What is a Transformer?*

*A Transformer is a deep learning architecture designed to understand relationships between words in a sequence using something called Attention Mechanism.*

*It became famous after the 2017 paper:*

*“Attention Is All You Need”*

*published by Google.*

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## *Simple Definition*

*A Transformer is an AI model that:*

- *reads input data,*
  - *understands context,*
  - *and generates meaningful output.*
- 

## *Example*

*Input:*

*“I love artificial intelligence”*

*Transformer understands:*

- *"love" relates to "artificial intelligence"*
- *"I" is the subject*
- *overall meaning = positive statement about AI*

*Then it can:*

- *translate it*
  - *summarize it*
  - *answer questions about it*
  - *generate similar text*
- 

## *Real-Life Analogy*

*Imagine reading a sentence:*

*"The animal didn't cross the road because IT was too tired."*

*You instantly know:*

- *"it" = animal*

*How?*

*Because your brain pays attention to relationships between words.*

*Transformers do the same thing mathematically using **Attention**.*

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# Why Were Transformers Created?

Before Transformers, people used:

- RNNs
- LSTMs

for sequence tasks like:

- translation
- speech recognition
- chatbots

But RNNs had major problems.

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## Problems with RNNs

### 1. Sequential Processing

RNN reads words one by one:

$I \rightarrow \text{love} \rightarrow AI$

This is slow because processing cannot happen in parallel.

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### 2. Long-Term Memory Problem

Example:

*"The boy who lived in France for 10 years finally returned because HE missed his family."*

*RNN may forget who "he" refers to because the important word is far away.*

*This is called: **Vanishing Gradient Problem***

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## ***Transformers Solved This***

*Transformers introduced:*

### ***Self-Attention***

*which allows the model to:*

- *look at ALL words together*
  - *understand relationships instantly*
  - *process everything in parallel*
- 

## ***Core Idea of Transformers***

*The core idea is:*

*Every word should be able to look at every other word.*



Example:

Sentence:

"The cat sat on the mat"

When processing "sat", the model can directly look at:

- cat
- mat
- on

and understand context.

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# Why Transformers Became Revolutionary

Transformers improved:

| Feature                  | RNN     | Transformer |
|--------------------------|---------|-------------|
| Speed                    | Slow    | Fast        |
| Parallel Processing      | No      | Yes         |
| Long-range understanding | Weak    | Strong      |
| GPU usage                | Poor    | Excellent   |
| Scalability              | Limited | Massive     |

# *Applications of Transformers*

*Transformers power:*

| <i>Application</i> | <i>Example</i> |
|--------------------|----------------|
|--------------------|----------------|

|                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| <i>Chatbots</i> | <i>ChatGPT</i> |
|-----------------|----------------|

|                    |                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| <i>Translation</i> | <i>Google Translate</i> |
|--------------------|-------------------------|

|               |                      |
|---------------|----------------------|
| <i>Search</i> | <i>Google Search</i> |
|---------------|----------------------|

|                  |                       |
|------------------|-----------------------|
| <i>Coding AI</i> | <i>GitHub Copilot</i> |
|------------------|-----------------------|

|                 |                            |
|-----------------|----------------------------|
| <i>Image AI</i> | <i>Vision Transformers</i> |
|-----------------|----------------------------|

|                  |                         |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| <i>Speech AI</i> | <i>Voice assistants</i> |
|------------------|-------------------------|

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## *Famous Transformer Models*

| <i>Model</i> | <i>Company</i> |
|--------------|----------------|
|--------------|----------------|

|             |               |
|-------------|---------------|
| <i>BERT</i> | <i>Google</i> |
|-------------|---------------|

|            |               |
|------------|---------------|
| <i>GPT</i> | <i>OpenAI</i> |
|------------|---------------|

|               |                  |
|---------------|------------------|
| <i>Claude</i> | <i>Anthropic</i> |
|---------------|------------------|

|               |               |
|---------------|---------------|
| <i>Gemini</i> | <i>Google</i> |
|---------------|---------------|

|              |             |
|--------------|-------------|
| <i>Llama</i> | <i>Meta</i> |
|--------------|-------------|

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## Important Technical Definition

A Transformer is:

A neural network architecture based primarily on self-attention mechanisms instead of recurrence.

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## Very Important Interview Question

Why is it called a Transformer?

Because it transforms:

Input Sequence  $\rightarrow$  Output Sequence

Example:

English  $\rightarrow$  French

"How are you?"  $\rightarrow$  "Comment ça va ?"



# Key Components of a Transformer

The Transformer contains:

1. Input Embedding
2. Positional Encoding
3. Encoder
4. Decoder
5. Self-Attention
6. Multi-Head Attention
7. Feed Forward Networks
8. Softmax Layer

We'll learn each separately in detail.

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## Architecture Overview

Transformer has 2 main blocks:

INPUT → ENCODER → DECODER → OUTPUT

The encoder understands input.

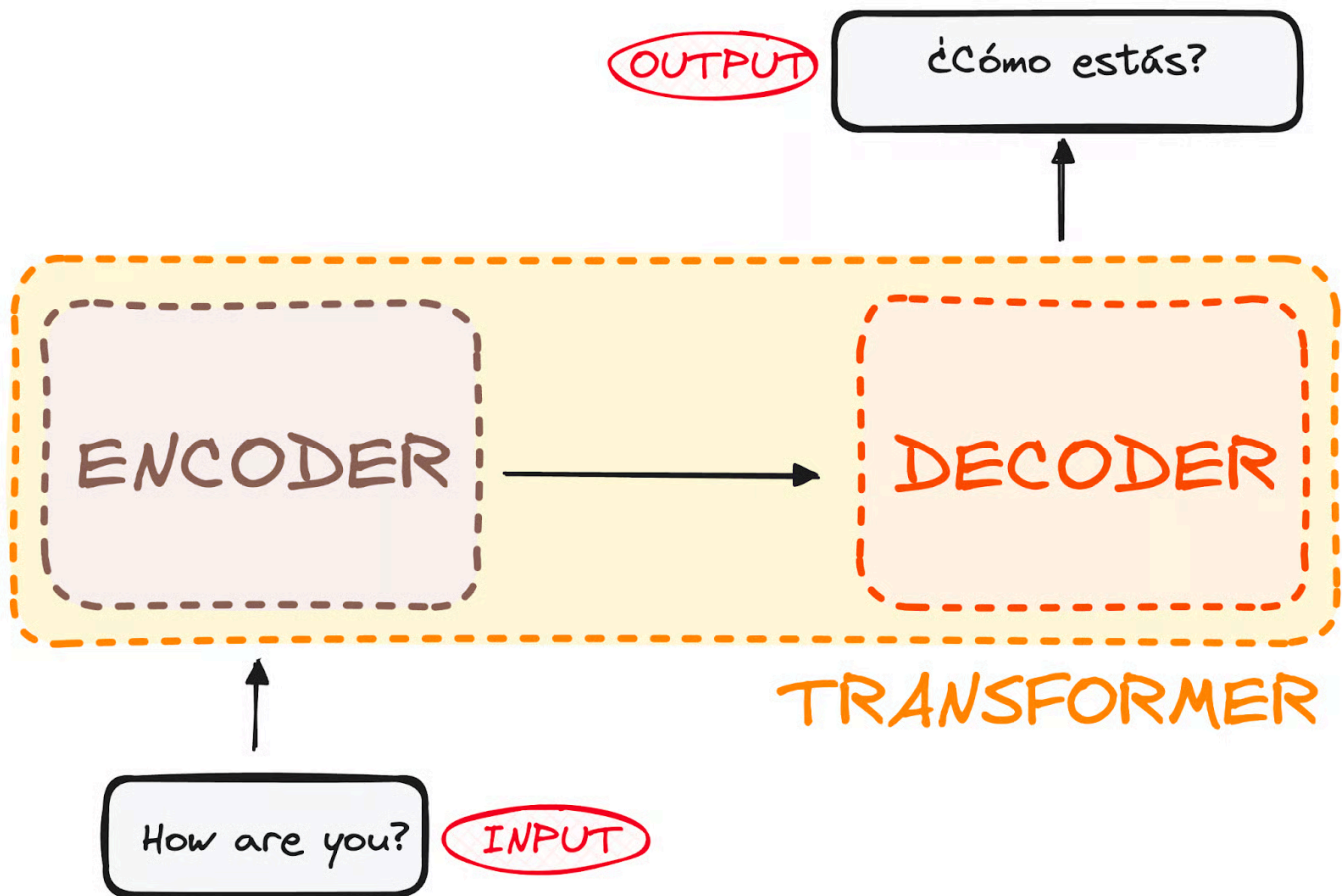
The decoder generates output.

**Encoder = Reader**

Reads and understands the sentence.

*Decoder = Writer*

*Writes the final answer.*



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## *Mini Example*

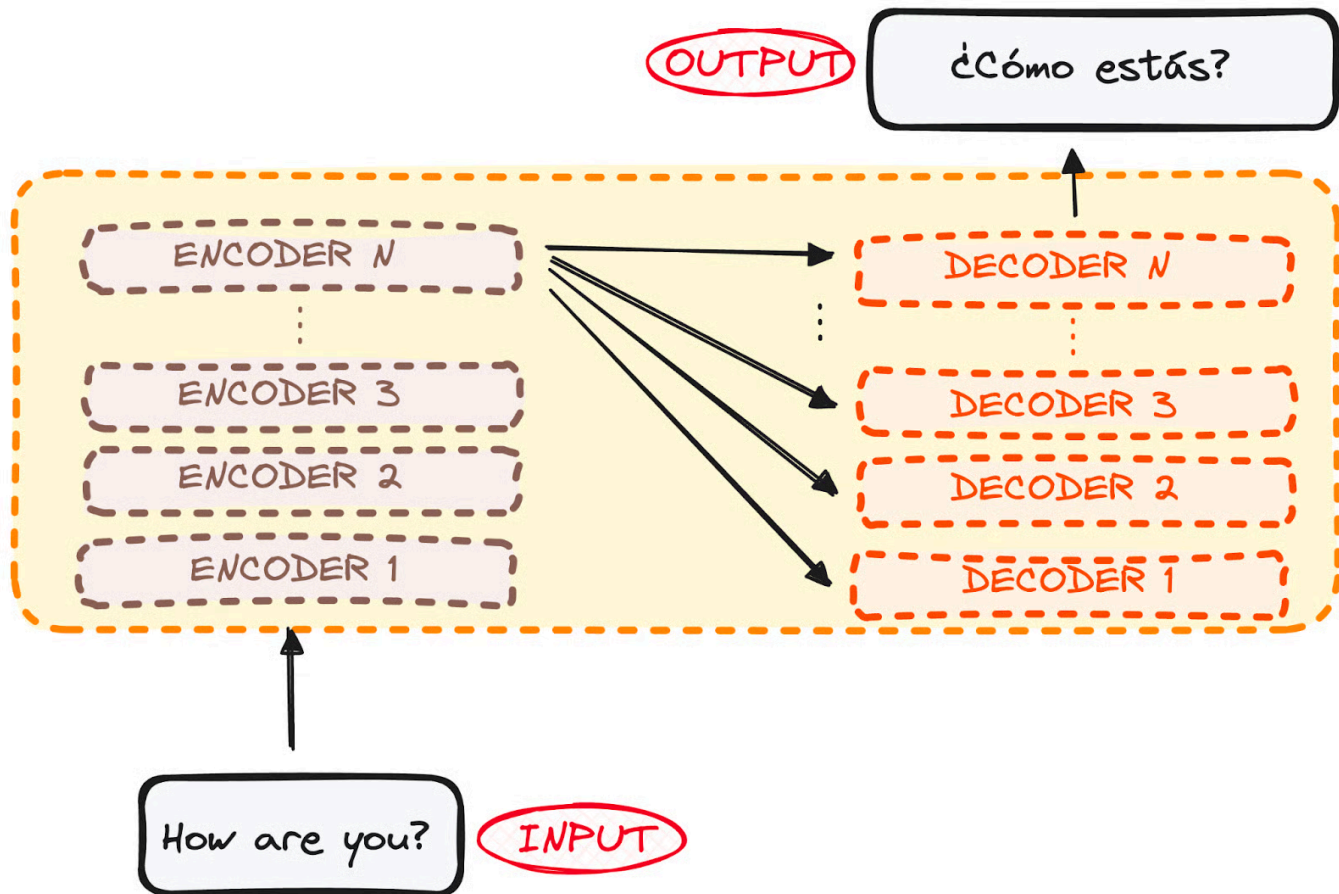
*Input:*

*"How are you?"*

Encoder understands meaning.

Decoder generates:

"¿Cómo estás?"



## THE ENCODER WORKFLOW (Heart of the Transformer)

This is one of the *MOST IMPORTANT* sections in Transformers.

If you fully understand the encoder, you understand almost 70% of Transformer architecture.

# *What is an Encoder?*

*The encoder is the understanding part of the Transformer.*

*Its job is:*

*Input Sentence → Meaningful Context Representation*

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## *Simple Definition*

*The encoder reads the sentence and creates a contextual understanding of every word.*

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## *Example*

*Sentence:*

*"The bank is near the river"*

*Encoder understands:*

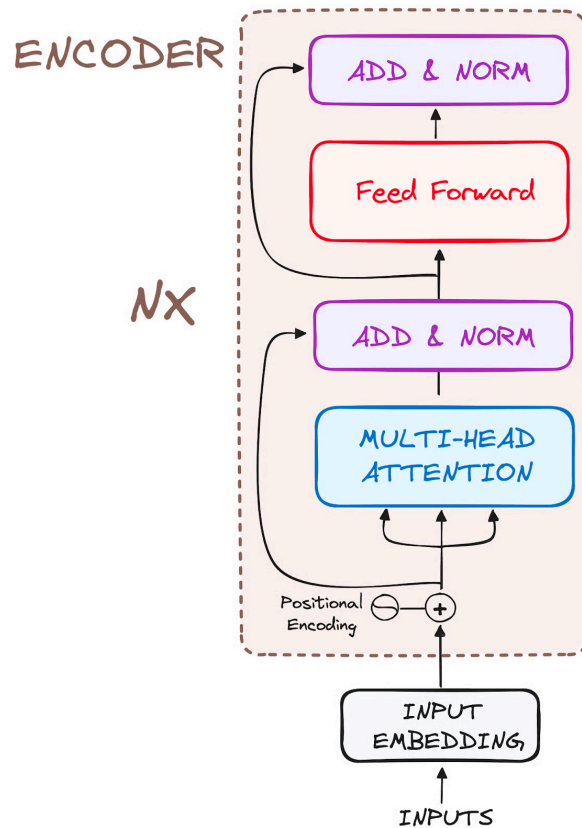
- *"bank" means river bank*

*NOT:*

- *bank account*

*because it analyzes nearby words like: river*

*This is called: Contextual Understanding*



## Real-Life Analogy

Imagine reading:

*"Apple released a new iPhone."*

You instantly know:

- Apple = company

NOT fruit.

Why?



*Because your brain uses context.*

*The encoder does the same thing mathematically.*

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## *Overall Encoder Flow*

*The encoder workflow is:*

*Input Tokens*



*Input Embeddings*



*Positional Encoding*



*Multi-Head Self Attention*



*Add & Normalize*



*Feed Forward Network*



*Add & Normalize*



*Output Context Vectors*

# Big Picture of Encoder

The encoder contains multiple identical layers.

Original Transformer:

- 6 Encoder Layers

Each layer improves understanding more deeply.

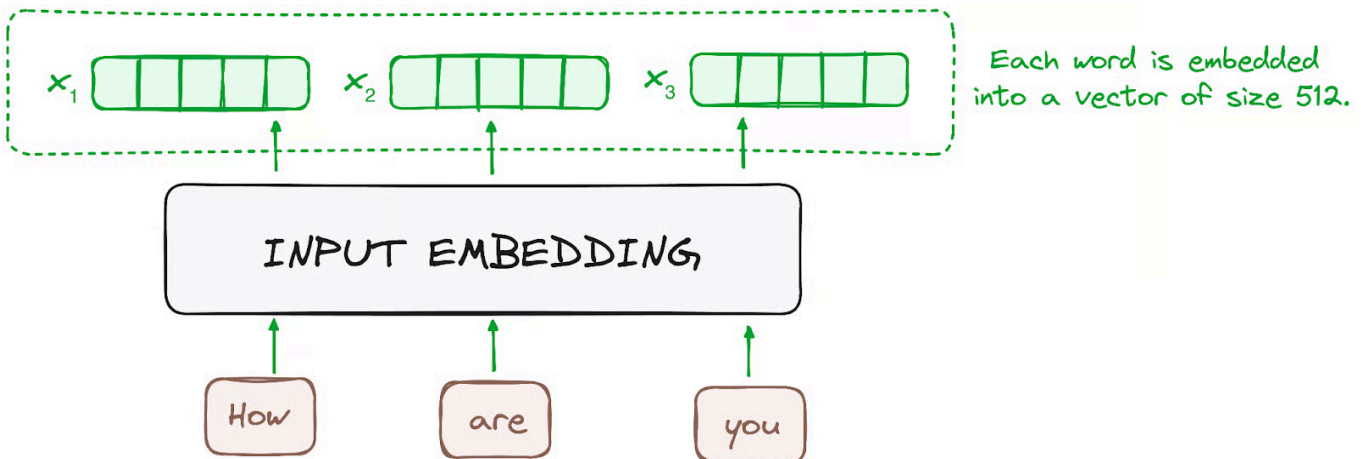
## STEP 1 – INPUT EMBEDDINGS

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### What is Embedding?

Computers cannot understand words directly.

So words are converted into numbers called: **Vectors / Embeddings**



## Example

*Sentence:*

*"I love AI"*

*After tokenization:*

*["I", "love", "AI"]*

*Embedding layer converts them into vectors:*

*"I" → [0.2, 0.8, 0.1, ...]*

*"love" → [0.9, 0.1, 0.7, ...]*

*"AI" → [0.5, 0.4, 0.6, ...]*

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## Why Embeddings Matter

*Embeddings capture semantic meaning.*

*Example:*

*King ≈ Queen*

*Dog ≈ Puppy*

*Similar words have similar vectors.*

*Original Transformer used:*

*512-dimensional vectors*

*That means each word becomes:*

*Vector size = 512*

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## *Key Note*

*Only the FIRST encoder receives actual word embeddings.*

*Other encoder layers receive outputs from previous encoder layers.*

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## *Simple Analogy*

*Embedding is like:*

*Word → Mathematical Identity Card*

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## *STEP 2 – POSITIONAL ENCODING*

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### *Problem Without Positional Encoding*

*Transformers process all words simultaneously.*

*So they DONT naturally know:*

- *first word*
  - *second word*
  - *sentence order*
- 

## *Example*

*These two sentences are different:*

*"Dog bites man"*

*"Man bites dog"*

*Without positional information:*

*Transformer may think both are similar.*

## *Solution = Positional Encoding*

*We add position information to embeddings.*

## *Formula Used*

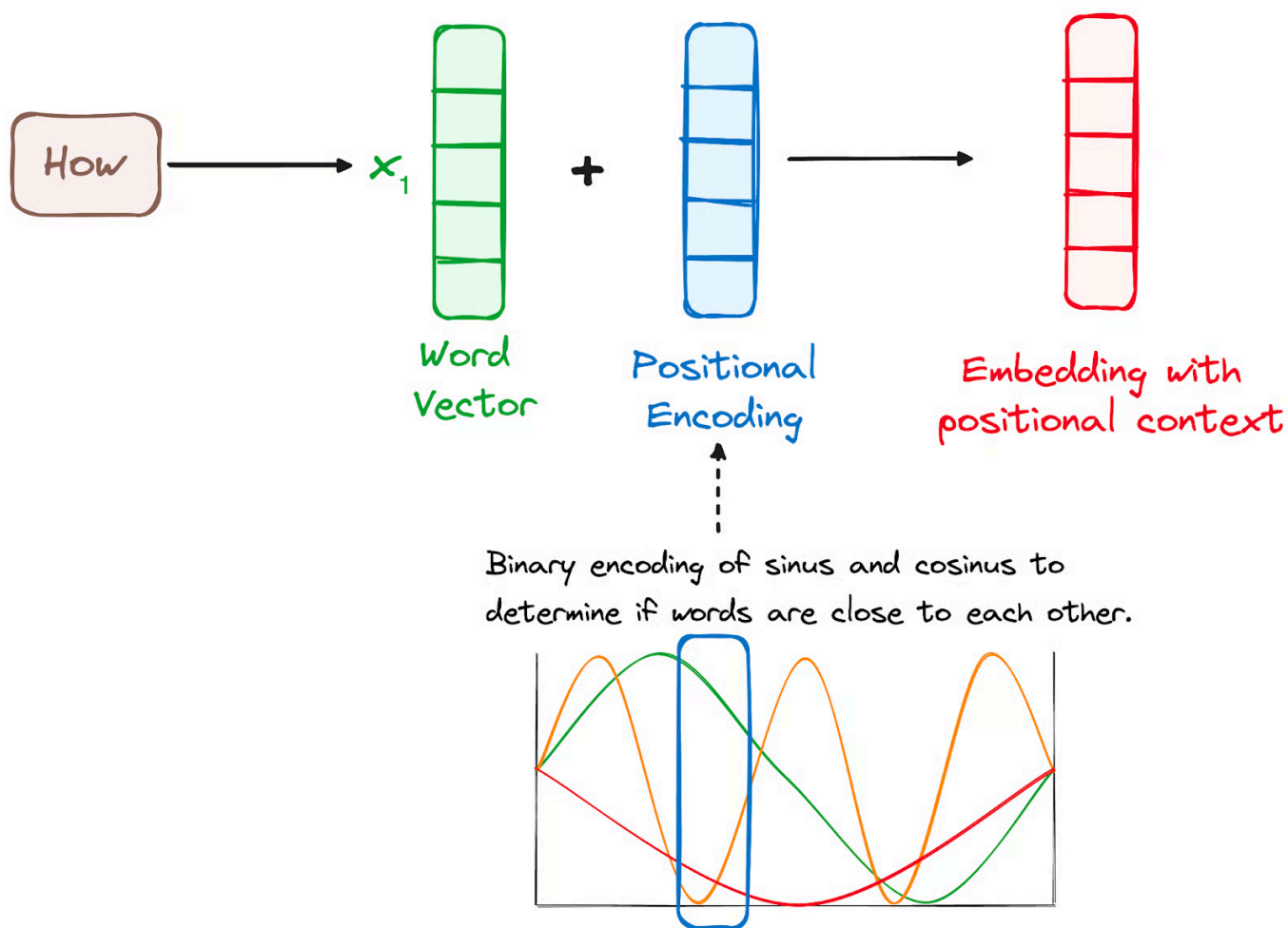
*Transformers use sine and cosine functions.*

*The positional encoding creates unique patterns for every position.*

## Important Idea

Each word gets:

Final Input = Word Embedding + Positional Encoding



## Example

Suppose:

$\text{Embedding}(\text{"cat"}) = [0.2, 0.5]$

*Position Encoding(2) = [0.1, 0.9]*

*Final vector:*

*[0.2, 0.5] + [0.1, 0.9]*

*=*

*[0.3, 1.4]*

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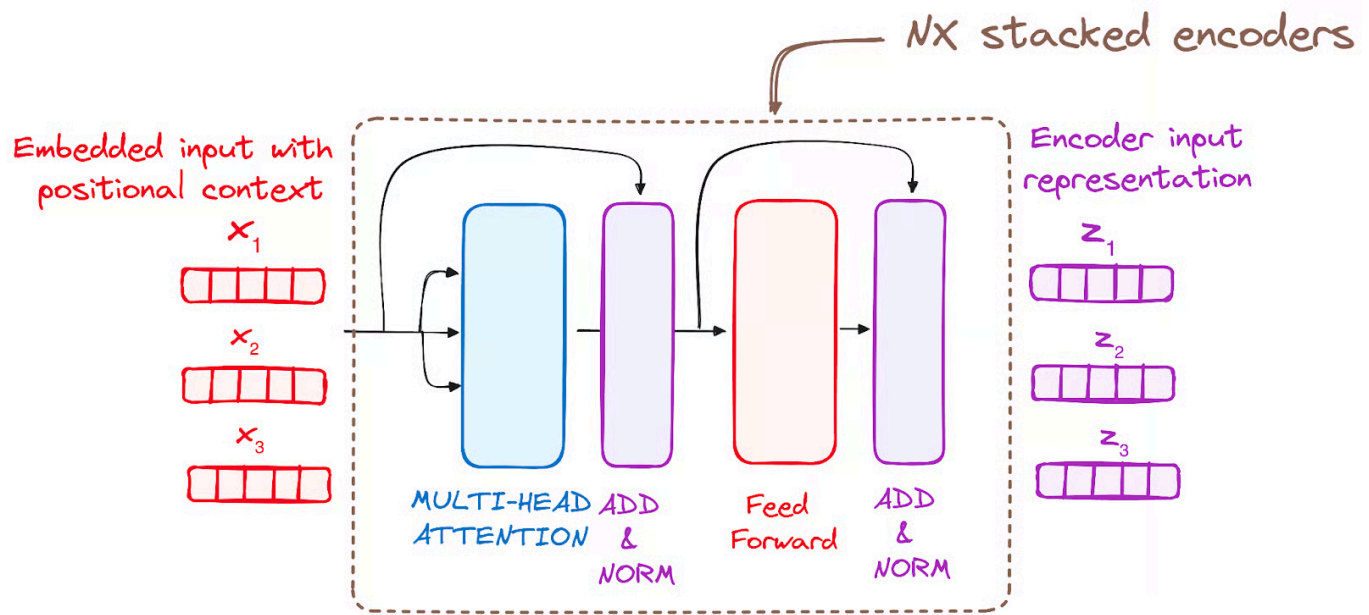
## *Why Sine & Cosine?*

*Because they:*

- *create unique position patterns*
  - *generalize to long sequences*
  - *preserve relative distances*
- 

## *STEP 3 – STACK OF ENCODER LAYERS*

*Now the real intelligence begins.*



## Structure of One Encoder Layer

Each encoder layer contains:

1. Multi-Head Self Attention
  2. Add & Normalize
  3. Feed Forward Network
  4. Add & Normalize
-



## *Visual Flow*

*Input*



*Multi-Head Attention*



*Add & Normalize*



*Feed Forward Network*



*Add & Normalize*



*Output*

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## *STEP 3.1 – SELF-ATTENTION*

*This is the MOST IMPORTANT concept in Transformers.*

*Self-Attention = Core of Transformers*

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## *Main Idea*

*Every word looks at every other word.*

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## *Example*

*Sentence:*

*"The animal didn't cross the road because it was tired"*

*When processing:*

*"it"*

*the model learns:*

*"it" → refers to "animal"*

## *Attention Mechanism Components*

*Self-attention uses:*

*Component*

*Meaning*

*Query (Q)    What am I looking for?*

*Key (K)    What information do I  
contain?*

*Value (V)    Actual information*

---

## *Real-Life Analogy*

*Think of YouTube search.*

*Query*

*Your search text.*

*Key*

*Video titles.*

*Value*

*Actual video content.*

*The best matching title gets highest attention.*

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## How Self-Attention Works

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### Step 1 – Create $Q$ , $K$ , $V$

Each word creates:

- Query vector
- Key vector
- Value vector

using learned matrices.

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### Example

Word:

"apple"

becomes:

$$Q = [1, 2, 3]$$

$$K = [0, 1, 1]$$

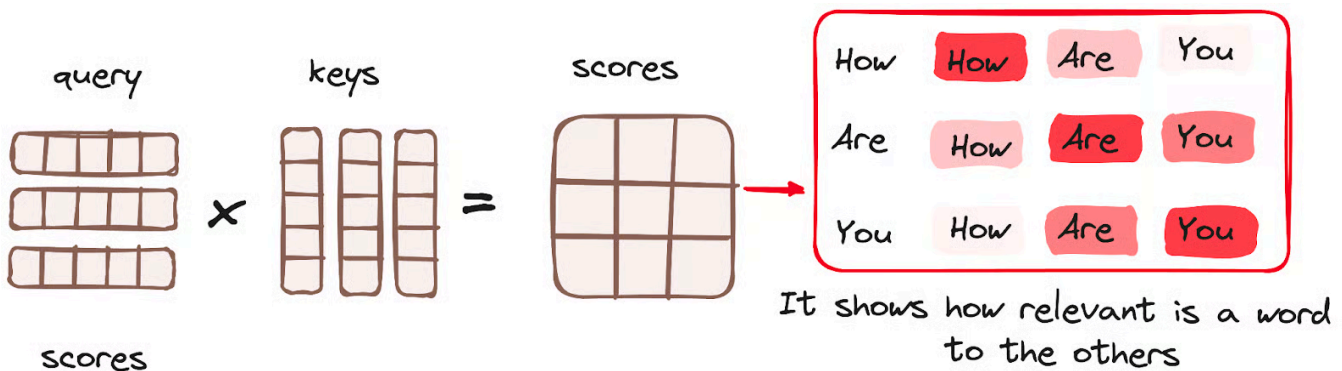
$$V = [5, 6, 7]$$

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## Step 2 – Calculate Attention Scores

We compare:

Query × Key



using dot product.

This tells:

How important is another word?

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## Mathematical Formula

The core attention equation is:

$$\text{Attention}(Q, K, V) = \text{softmax}\left(\frac{QK^T}{\sqrt{d_k}}\right)V$$

## Meaning of Formula

| Part | Meaning |
|------|---------|
|------|---------|

|        |                  |
|--------|------------------|
| $QK^T$ | Similarity score |
|--------|------------------|

|              |                |
|--------------|----------------|
| $\sqrt{d_k}$ | Scaling factor |
|--------------|----------------|

|         |                           |
|---------|---------------------------|
| Softmax | Converts to probabilities |
|---------|---------------------------|

|     |                               |
|-----|-------------------------------|
| $V$ | Final weighted<br>information |
|-----|-------------------------------|

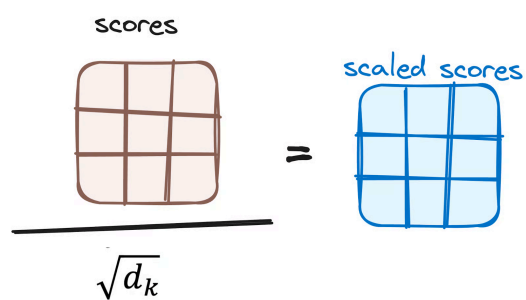
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### Step 3 – Scaling

Scores become very large sometimes.

So we divide by:

$\sqrt{d_k}$

$$\frac{\text{scores}}{\sqrt{d_k}} = \text{scaled scores}$$


*This stabilizes gradients.*

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## Step 4 – Softmax

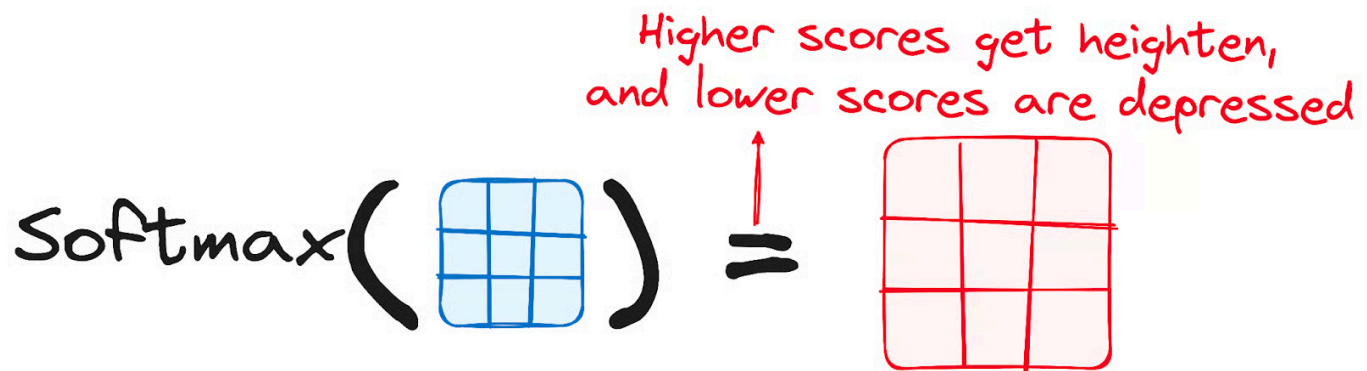
*Softmax converts scores into probabilities:*

$[2.1, 1.3, 0.2]$

↓

$[0.7, 0.2, 0.1]$

*Higher score = more attention.*



## Step 5 – Multiply with Values

*Attention weights multiply with value vectors.*

*Important words get amplified.*

*Unimportant words get reduced.*

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## *Final Output*

*The output becomes:*

*Context-aware representation*

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## *MULTI-HEAD ATTENTION*

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### *Why Multiple Heads?*

*One attention head may learn:*

- *grammar*

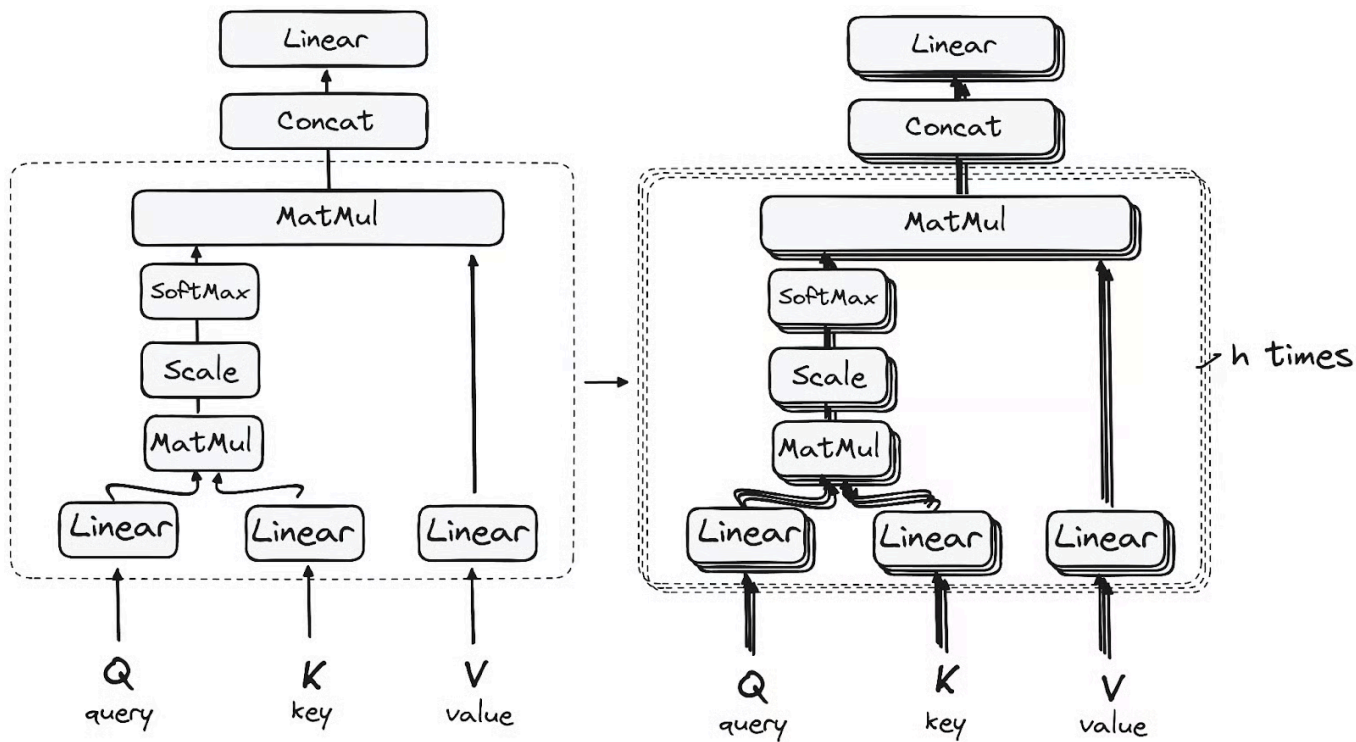
*Another may learn:*

- *subject-object relation*

*Another may learn:*

- *semantic meaning*





## Example

Sentence:

"The boy kicked the ball"

Different heads may focus on:

Head      Learns

Head 1      boy ↔ kicked

Head 2      kicked  $\leftrightarrow$  ball

Head 3    Sentence structure

---

## *Important Point*

*Attention happens multiple times in parallel.*

*Then outputs are combined.*

*This is: Multi-Head Attention*

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## *STEP 3.2 – RESIDUAL CONNECTION + NORMALIZATION*

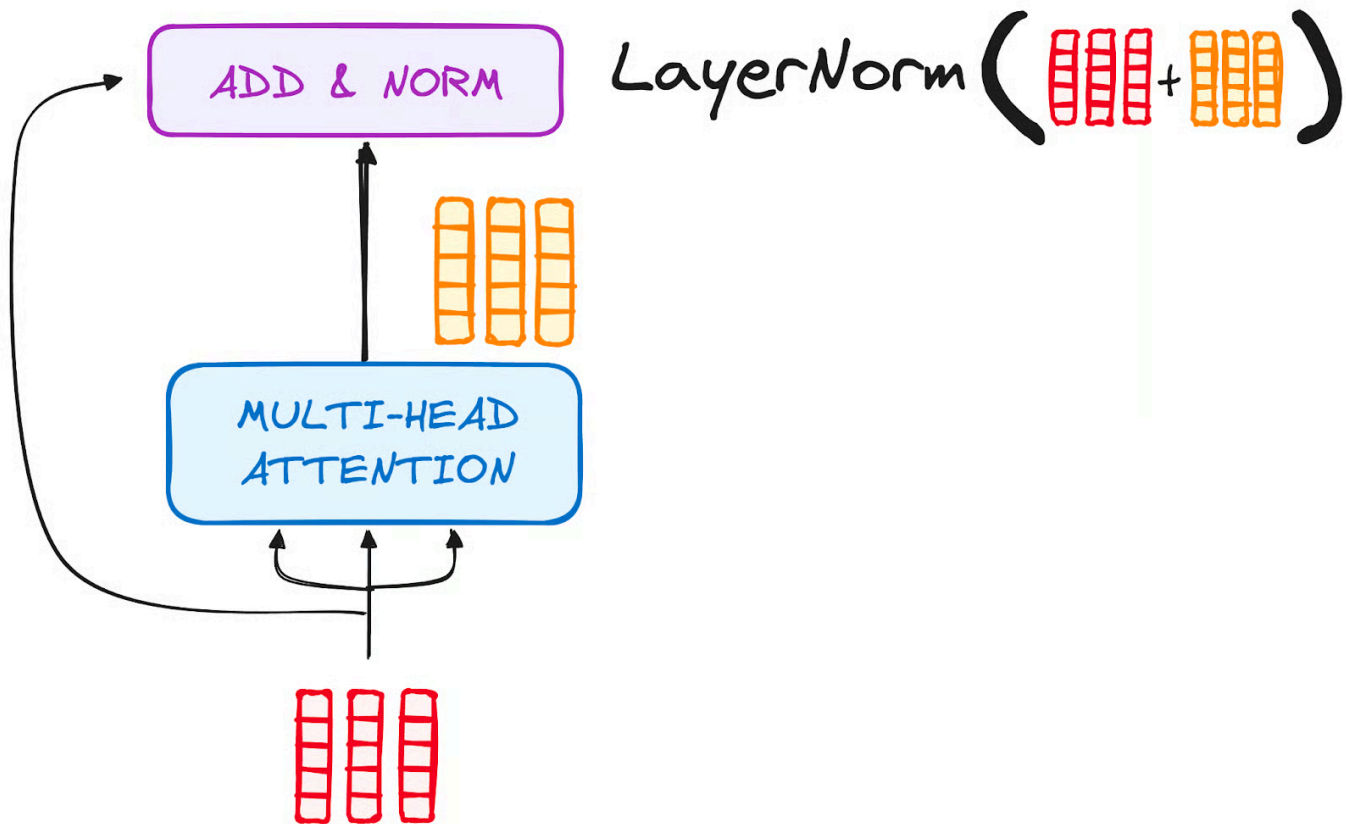
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### *Residual Connection*

*We add input back to output.*

*Formula:*

$$\text{Output} = \text{Layer}(x) + x$$



---

*Why?*

*Helps prevent:*

*Vanishing Gradient Problem*

*Allows deep networks.*

*Layer Normalization*

*Normalizes values for stable learning.*

*Benefits:*

- *faster training*
  - *stable gradients*
  - *better convergence*
- 

## *Simple Analogy*

*Residual connection is like:*

*"Keep original notes while improving them"*

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## *STEP 3.3 – FEED FORWARD NETWORK (FFN)*

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### *What is FFN?*

*A small neural network applied independently to every token.*

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### *Structure*

*Usually:*

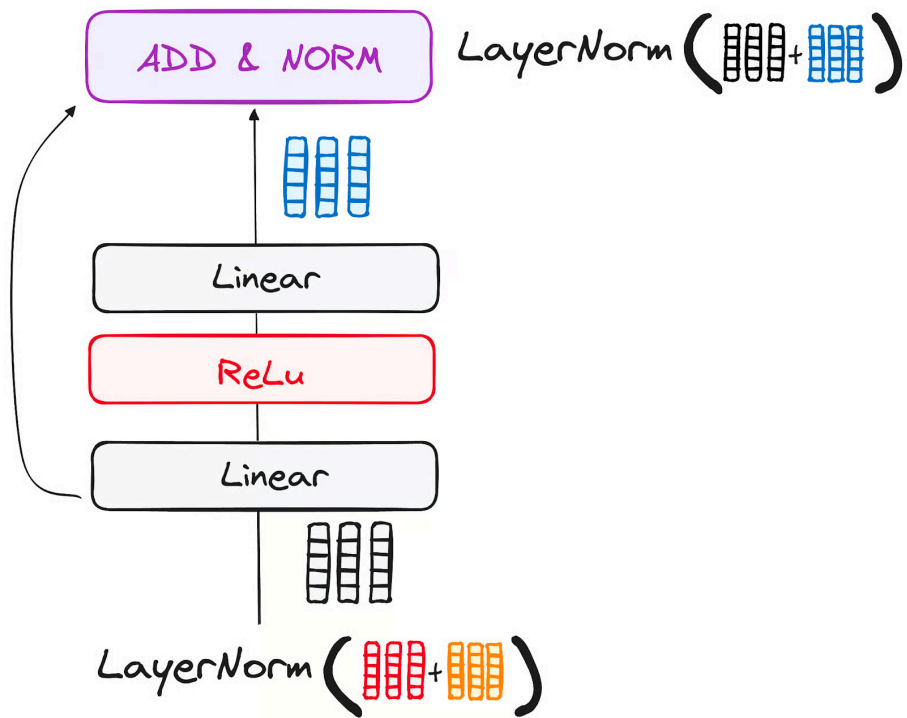
*Linear*



ReLU



Linear



Formula

$$\text{FFN}(x) = \max(0, xW_1 + b_1)W_2 + b_2$$

Purpose

FFN helps:

- learn deeper features
- refine representations
- improve abstraction

---

## *Simple Analogy*

*Attention = gathering information*

*FFN = processing information deeply*

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## *STEP 4 – OUTPUT OF ENCODER*

*After all encoder layers:*

*we get:*

## *Contextualized Representations*

*Every word now understands:*

- *grammar*
  - *meaning*
  - *relationships*
  - *sentence context*
- 

## *Example*

*Input:*

*"The bank near the river"*

*Encoder output understands:*

*bank = river bank*

*NOT financial bank.*

## ***PART 3 – DECODER WORKFLOW (Text Generation Engine)***

*Now we move to the second major component of Transformers:*

### ***The Decoder***

*If the encoder is the reader, then the decoder is the writer.*

*The decoder generates the final output sequence word by word.*

---

### ***What is the Decoder?***

*The decoder is responsible for:*

*Generating output tokens one by one*

---

### ***Example***

*Input:*

*"How are you?"*

*Encoder understands meaning.*

*Decoder generates:*

*"¿Cómo estás?"*

*step by step.*

---

## *Main Goal of Decoder*

*The decoder:*

- *reads encoder output*
  - *looks at previously generated words*
  - *predicts next word*
- 

## *Real-Life Analogy*

*Imagine translating English to Spanish.*

*Encoder*

*Understands the English sentence.*



*Decoder*

*Writes the Spanish sentence word by word.*

---

## *Important Concept*

*The decoder works:*

*Autoregressively*

*Meaning:*

*Previous words → predict next word*

---

## *Example of Autoregressive Generation*

*Suppose output sentence is:*

*"I love AI"*

*Generation happens like:*

*START → "I"*

*"I" → "love"*

*"I love" → "AI"*

"I love AI" → END

---

# Overall Decoder Workflow

Previous Output Tokens



Output Embedding



Positional Encoding



Masked Multi-Head Attention



Add & Normalize



Cross Attention



Add & Normalize



Feed Forward Network



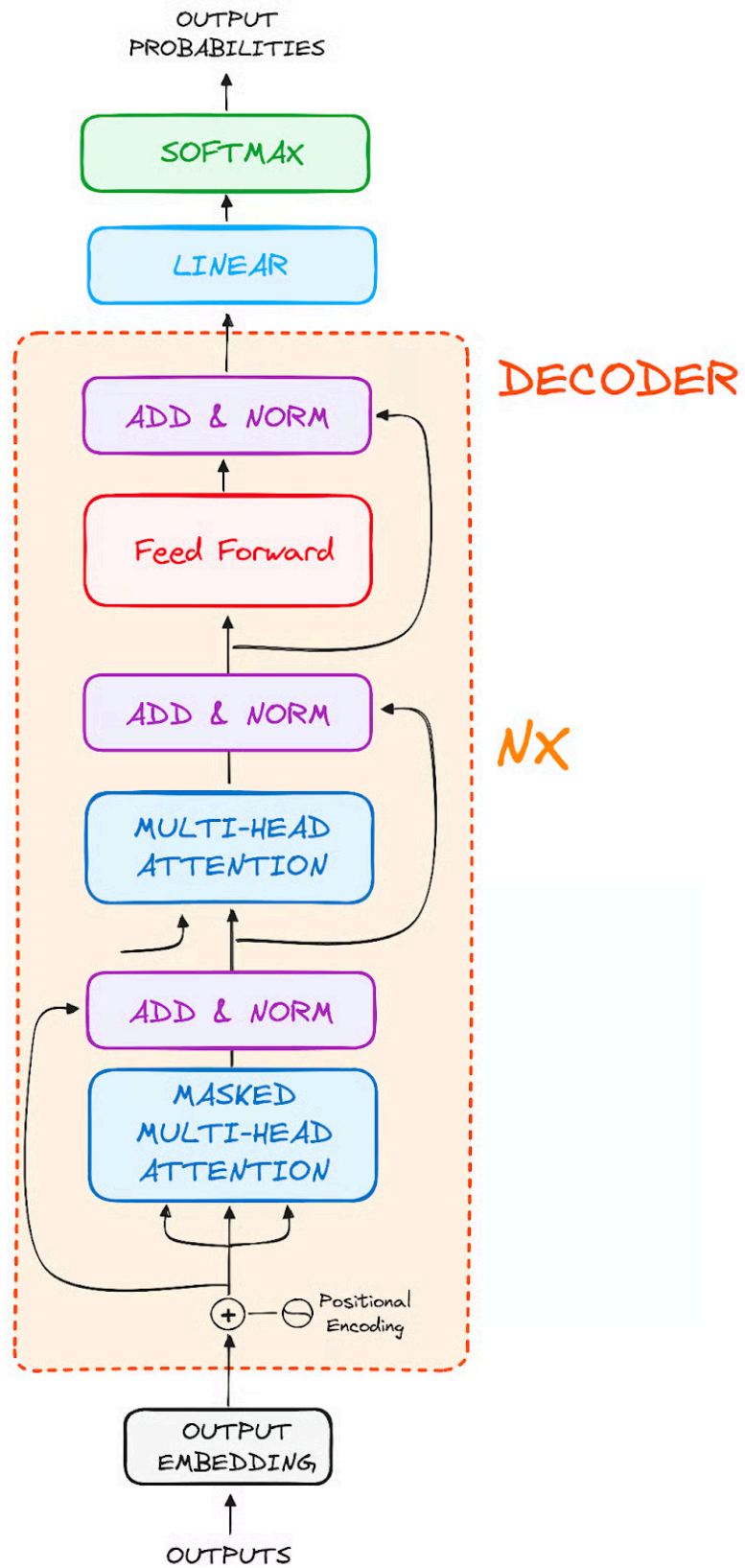
Add & Normalize



Linear + Softmax



Next Word Prediction



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## Decoder Main Components

| Component             | Purpose                            |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|
| Output Embedding      | Convert output words into vectors  |
| Positional Encoding   | Add sequence order                 |
| Masked Self-Attention | Prevent cheating from future words |
| Cross Attention       | Connect encoder + decoder          |
| FeedForward Network   | Deep processing                    |
| Linear Layer          | Vocabulary scoring                 |
| Softmax               | Probability generation             |

---

## STEP 1 – OUTPUT EMBEDDINGS

## *What Happens Here?*

*Just like encoder input embeddings:*

*decoder converts output tokens into vectors.*

---

## *Example*

*Suppose decoder already generated:*

*"I love"*

*Embeddings:*

*"I"  $\rightarrow [0.3, 0.1, \dots]$*

*"love"  $\rightarrow [0.8, 0.5, \dots]$*

---

## *Important Point*

*Decoder uses:*

- *previously generated outputs*
  - *as new inputs*
-

## STEP 2 – POSITIONAL ENCODING

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### *Why Needed?*

*Decoder also processes tokens in parallel.*

*So it must know word order.*

---

### *Formula*

*Same as encoder:*

*Final Vector = Embedding + Positional Encoding*

---

### *Example*

*Sentence:*

*"I love AI"*

*Position info:*

*Word    Position*

*I            1*

*love       2*

*AI          3*

---

## *Important Point*

*Encoder and decoder BOTH use positional encoding.*

---

## *STEP 3 – STACK OF DECODER LAYERS*

*Decoder contains multiple identical layers.*

*Original Transformer:*

*6 Decoder Layers*

---

## Structure of One Decoder Layer

Each decoder layer has:

1. Masked Self-Attention
  2. Cross Attention
  3. Feed Forward Network
- 

## Visual Flow

Input



Masked Self Attention



Add & Normalize



Cross Attention



Add & Normalize



Feed Forward Network



Add & Normalize



Output



---

## STEP 3.1 – MASKED SELF-ATTENTION

*This is VERY IMPORTANT.*

---

### *What is Masking?*

*The decoder must NOT see future words.*

---

### *Example*

*Suppose target sentence:*

*"I love AI"*

*When predicting:*

*"love"*

*decoder should only see:*

*"I"*

*NOT:*

*"AI"*

*Otherwise model cheats.*

## *Why is This Important?*

*During training:*

*entire sentence is available.*

*Without masking:*

*model could simply copy future words.*

*That would destroy learning.*

---

## *Masking Concept*

*Future positions are hidden using a mask matrix.*

---

## *Example Mask Matrix*

*For sentence length = 4*

|      |     |     |      |
|------|-----|-----|------|
| $[1$ | $0$ | $0$ | $0$  |
| $1$  | $1$ | $0$ | $0$  |
| $1$  | $1$ | $1$ | $0$  |
| $1$  | $1$ | $1$ | $1]$ |

---

Meaning

Row    Visible Words

Word    Only itself  
1

Word    Words 1-2  
2

Word    Words 1-3  
3

Word    Words 1-4  
4

scaled scores

|     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|
| 0.5 | 0.2 | 0.1 |
| 0.1 | 0.6 | 0.2 |
| 0.1 | 0.2 | 0.3 |

+

Look-ahead mask

|   |      |      |
|---|------|------|
| 0 | -inf | -inf |
| 0 | 0    | -inf |
| 0 | 0    | 0    |

=

Masked Scores

|     |      |      |
|-----|------|------|
| 0.5 | -inf | -inf |
| 0.1 | 0.6  | -inf |
| 0.1 | 0.2  | 0.3  |

→

## *Important Concept*

*Decoder prediction depends ONLY on:*

*Past words*

*Never future words.*

---

## *Self-Attention Inside Decoder*

*Works similarly to encoder attention:*

- *Query*
- *Key*
- *Value*

*But with masking applied.*

---

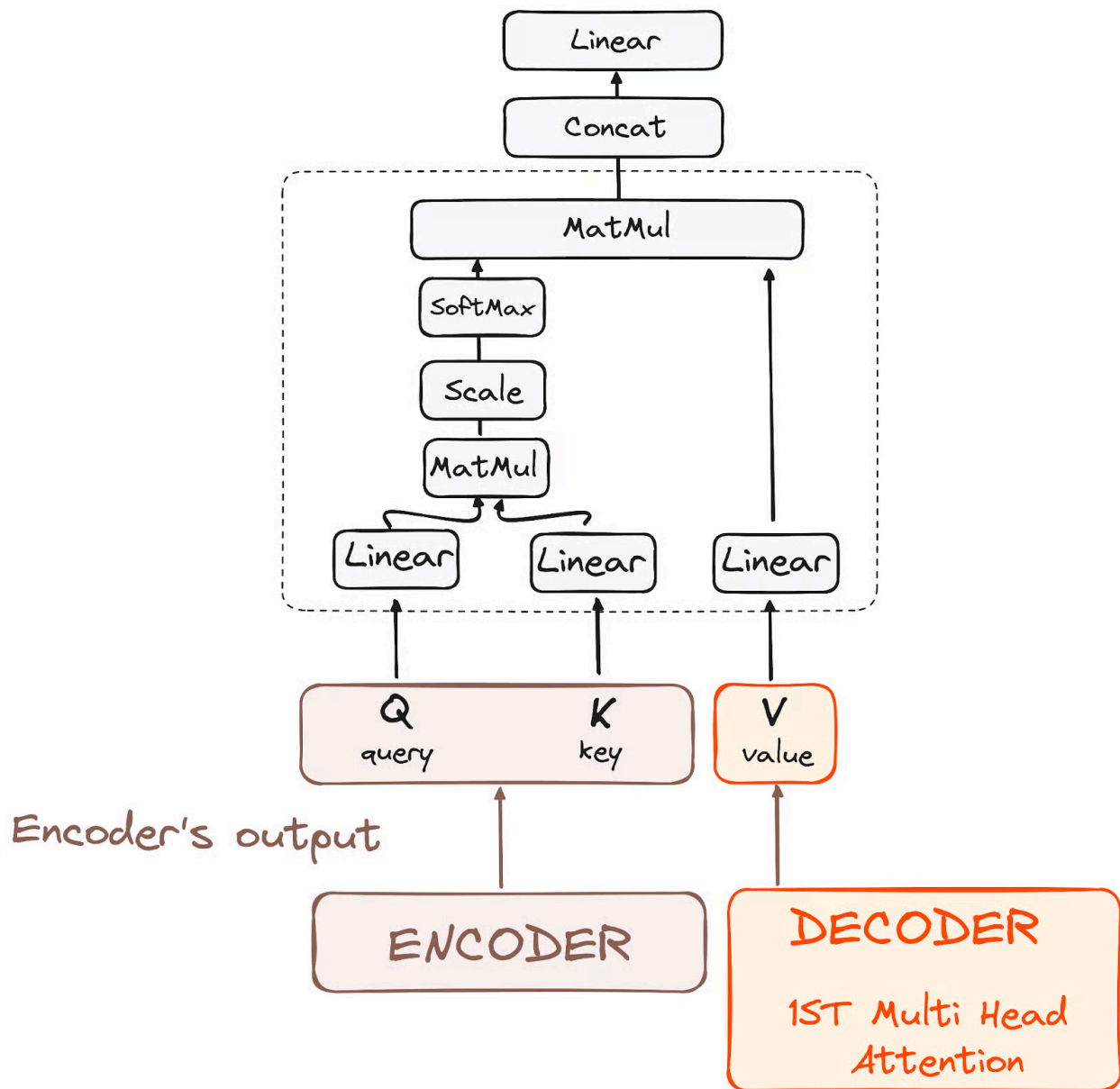
## *STEP 3.2 – CROSS ATTENTION (Encoder-Decoder Attention)*

*This is where:*

*Encoder and Decoder communicate.*

---

## Main Idea



Decoder asks encoder:

"Which input words are important right now?"

---

## *Example Translation*

*Input:*

*"How are you?"*

*Output generation:*

*"¿Cómo estás?"*

*When generating:*

*"estás"*

*decoder focuses on:*

*"are you"*

*from encoder output.*

---

## *Important Technical Detail*

*In cross attention:*

*Component Comes From*

*Query          Decoder*

*Key          Encoder*

*Value          Encoder*

---

## *Core Idea*

*Decoder uses encoder information to generate relevant output.*

---

## *Real-Life Analogy*

*Think of:*

*Encoder = textbook*

*Decoder = student writing answers*

*Student looks back at textbook while writing.*

*That is cross attention.*

---

## *STEP 3.3 – FEED FORWARD NETWORK*

Same as encoder FFN.

Structure:

Linear



ReLU



Linear

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## Purpose

Further processing and refinement.

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## Formula

$$FFN(x) = \max(0, xW_1 + b_1)W_2 + b_2$$

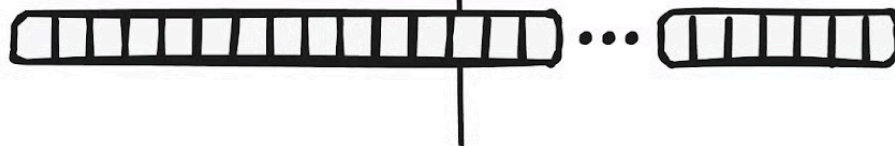
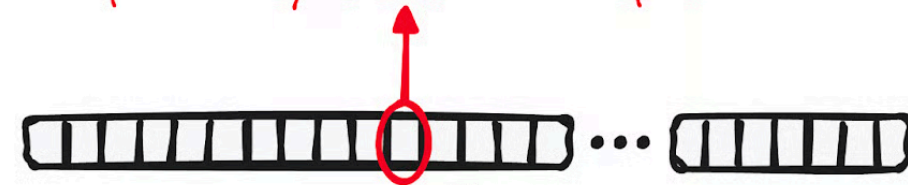
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## STEP 4 – LINEAR LAYER + SOFTMAX

Now decoder predicts next word.



The word with the highest probability is the final output



$N$  class  
(vocabulary size)



---

## Linear Layer

Transforms decoder output into vocabulary scores.

Suppose vocabulary contains:

10000 words

Then output becomes:

10000 scores

---

## Example

Suppose scores are:

cat  $\rightarrow$  2.5

dog  $\rightarrow$  1.2

apple  $\rightarrow$  0.3

---

## Softmax Layer

*Softmax converts scores into probabilities.*

---

## *Formula*

$$\text{Attention}(Q, K, V) = \text{Softmax}(QK^T / \sqrt{d_k})V$$

---

## *Example*

*After softmax:*

*cat  $\rightarrow$  0.75*

*dog  $\rightarrow$  0.20*

*apple  $\rightarrow$  0.05*

---

## *Final Prediction*

*Highest probability wins.*

*Predicted word:*

*"cat"*

---

## *END TOKEN*

*Generation continues until model predicts:*

*<END>*

*which means:*

*Sentence complete*

---

## *Full Decoder Example*

*Suppose translation task:*

*Input:*

*"I love AI"*

---

## *Generation Process*

*START*



*"I"*

↓

*"I love"*

↓

*"I love AI"*

↓

*END*

*One word generated at a time.*

---

## *Decoder vs Encoder*

| <i>Feature</i>              | <i>Encoder</i>          | <i>Decoder</i>                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <i>Main Role</i>            | <i>Understand input</i> | <i>Generate output</i>          |
| <i>Attention Type</i>       | <i>Self-attention</i>   | <i>Masked + Cross attention</i> |
| <i>Sees Future Tokens?</i>  | <i>Yes</i>              | <i>No</i>                       |
| <i>Uses Encoder Output?</i> | <i>No</i>               | <i>Yes</i>                      |

# REAL-LIFE TRANSFORMER MODELS

## 1. BERT (Google)



*Full Form*

*Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers*

*Architecture*

*Encoder Only*

*Main Idea*

*Understands text using both left and right context.*

*Example*

*"The bank near the river"*

*BERT understands:*

*bank = river bank*

*Applications*

- *Google Search*
- *Question Answering*
- *Text Classification*

*Memory Trick*

*BERT = Understands Text*

---

## 2. GPT / ChatGPT (OpenAI)



*Full Form*

*Generative Pretrained Transformer*

*Architecture*

*Decoder Only*

*Main Idea*

*Generates text one word at a time.*

*Example*

*"Once upon a time..."*

*GPT predicts the next words.*

*Applications*

- *ChatGPT*
- *AI Writing*
- *Coding Assistants*

*Memory Trick*

*GPT = Generates Text*

---

### 3. LaMDA (Google)



*Full Form*

*Language Model for Dialogue Applications*

*Main Idea*

*Built for conversations and chat systems.*

*Applications*

- *Virtual Assistants*
- *Conversational AI*

*Memory Trick*

*LaMDA = Conversation AI*

---

### 4. Claude (Anthropic)



*Main Idea*



*AI assistant focused on:*

- *safety*
- *reasoning*
- *long context understanding*

*Special Feature*

*Constitutional AI*

*Memory Trick*

*Claude = Safe AI*

---

## *5. Vision Transformers (ViT)*

*Main Idea*

*Processes images using Transformer architecture.*

*Images are divided into:*

*small patches*

*Applications*

- *Image Classification*

- *Object Detection*

*Memory Trick*

*ViT = Transformer for Images*

---

## *6. Multimodal Transformers*

*Main Idea*

*Processes multiple input types together:*

- *text*
- *image*
- *audio*
- *video*

*Example Models*

- *GPT-5*
- *Gemini*
- *Llama*

*Memory Trick*

*Multimodal = Multiple Input Types*

---

## *LIMITATIONS OF TRANSFORMERS*

- *High memory usage*
  - *Expensive training*
  - *Hallucinations*
  - *Long context is computationally expensive*
- 

## *TRANSFORMERS – INTERVIEW QUESTIONS & ANSWERS NOTES*

---

### *BASIC QUESTIONS*

#### *1. What is a Transformer?*

*A Transformer is a deep learning architecture that uses self-attention mechanisms to process sequential data in parallel.*

---

#### *2. Why were Transformers introduced?*

*Transformers were introduced to solve problems in RNNs such as:*

- *slow sequential processing*
  - *difficulty handling long-range dependencies*
-

3. What is the main innovation in Transformers?

*Self-Attention Mechanism*

---

4. What is self-attention?

*Self-attention allows every word in a sentence to focus on all other words to understand context.*

---

5. Why are Transformers faster than RNNs?

*Because Transformers process all words in parallel instead of sequentially.*

---

## ARCHITECTURE QUESTIONS

6. What are the two main components of a Transformer?

*Encoder and Decoder*

---

7. What is the role of the Encoder?

*Encoder understands the input sentence and creates contextual representations.*

---

### 8. What is the role of the Decoder?

*Decoder generates output text word by word.*

---

### 9. What is Input Embedding?

*Converting words into numerical vectors.*

---

### 10. Why is Positional Encoding needed?

*Because Transformers do not process words sequentially and need position information.*

---

## SELF-ATTENTION QUESTIONS

### 11. What are Query, Key, and Value?

| <i>Component</i> | <i>Purpose</i>                            |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <i>Query</i>     | <i>What the word is searching for</i>     |
| <i>Key</i>       | <i>What information the word contains</i> |
| <i>Value</i>     | <i>Actual information passed forward</i>  |

---

## 12. What is Multi-Head Attention?

*Using multiple attention mechanisms in parallel to learn different relationships.*

---

## 13. Why is Multi-Head Attention important?

*Different heads learn:*

- *grammar*
  - *semantics*
  - *relationships*
  - *sentence structure*
- 

## 14. What is the purpose of Softmax in attention?

*Softmax converts attention scores into probabilities.*

---

## 15. Why are attention scores scaled?

*To prevent extremely large values and stabilize training.*

---

# ENCODER QUESTIONS

## 16. What are the main parts of an Encoder layer?

- *Multi-Head Self Attention*
- *Feed Forward Network*

- *Residual Connection*
  - *Layer Normalization*
- 

### *17. What is a Feed Forward Network (FFN)?*

*A small neural network used for deeper processing after attention.*

---

### *18. Why are Residual Connections used?*

*To prevent vanishing gradient problems and enable deeper networks.*

---

### *19. What is Layer Normalization?*

*A technique used to stabilize and speed up training.*

---

## *DECODER QUESTIONS*

### *20. What is Masked Self-Attention?*

*A decoder mechanism that prevents the model from seeing future words.*

---

### *21. Why is masking important?*

*To avoid cheating during text generation.*

---

## 22. What is Cross Attention?

*Decoder attending to encoder outputs.*

---

## 23. What does autoregressive generation mean?

*Generating text one token at a time using previous outputs.*

---

# MODEL QUESTIONS

## 24. What architecture does BERT use?

*Encoder Only*

---

## 25. What architecture does GPT use?

*Decoder Only*

---

## 26. What is BERT mainly used for?

- *Understanding tasks*
- *Question Answering*
- *Text Classification*



---

27. What is GPT mainly used for?

- Text Generation
  - Chatbots
  - Content Writing
- 

28. What is LaMDA?

*A Transformer model designed for conversations and dialogue systems.*

---

29. What is Claude known for?

- Safety
  - Reasoning
  - Long-context understanding
- 

30. What are Vision Transformers (ViT)?

*Transformers applied to image processing tasks.*

---

## COMPARISON QUESTIONS

31. Difference between RNN and Transformer?

*RNN*

*Transformer*

*Sequential*

*Parallel*

*Slow*

*Fast*

*Weak long memory*

*Strong long memory*

---

### *32. Difference between CNN and Transformer?*

*CNN*

*Transformer*

*Best for images*

*Best for NLP + multimodal*

*Limited context*

*Strong context understanding*

---

## *ADVANCED QUESTIONS*

### *33. What is Flash Attention?*

*An optimized attention mechanism that reduces GPU memory usage and speeds up training.*

---

### *34. What is RoPE?*

*Rotary Position Embedding*

*Used for better long-sequence understanding.*

---

### *35. What is Mixture of Experts (MoE)?*

*Only a subset of model parameters activate for each task.*

---

### *36. What are Multimodal Transformers?*

*Models that process:*

- *text*
- *image*
- *audio*
- *video*

*together.*

---

## *LIMITATION QUESTIONS*

### *37. What are the limitations of Transformers?*

- *High memory usage*
- *Expensive training*
- *Hallucinations*
- *Quadratic complexity*

---

38. What is hallucination in AI?

*Generating incorrect information confidently.*

---

39. Why are Transformers computationally expensive?

*Because self-attention compares every token with every other token.*

---

## IMPORTANT ONE-LINERS

40. Why is “Attention Is All You Need” famous?

*Because it introduced the Transformer architecture.*

---

41. Why are Transformers important in AI?

*They revolutionized NLP and power modern AI systems like ChatGPT and Claude.*

---

## VERY IMPORTANT INTERVIEW QUESTION

42. Explain Transformer workflow in simple terms.

*Input*



*Embedding*



*Positional Encoding*



*Self Attention*



*Encoder Understanding*



*Decoder Generation*



*Output Text*

---

## *PRACTICAL IMPLEMENTATIONS:*

# =====

# MINI GPT / TRANSFORMER FROM SCRATCH

# Beginner-Friendly Full Implementation

# =====

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 1 — IMPORT LIBRARIES
```

```
# =====
```

```
import torch
```

```
import torch.nn as nn
```

```
import torch.optim as optim
```

```
import math
```

```
print("Libraries Imported Successfully")
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 2 — SAMPLE TRAINING TEXT
```

```
# =====
```

```
text = "i love ai and ai loves humans"
```

```
print("\nTraining Text:")
```

```
print(text)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 3 — TOKENIZATION
```

```
# =====
```

```
tokens = text.split()
```

```
print("\nTokens:")
```

```
print(tokens)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 4 — BUILD VOCABULARY
```

```
# =====
```

```
vocab = sorted(set(tokens))
```

```
word_to_idx = {
```

```
    word: idx for idx, word in enumerate(vocab)
```

```
}
```

```
idx_to_word = {
```

```
    idx: word for word, idx in word_to_idx.items()
```

```
}
```

```
print("\nVocabulary:")
```

```
print(word_to_idx)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 5 — CONVERT TOKENS TO IDS
```

```
# =====
```

```
token_ids = [word_to_idx[word] for word in tokens]
```

```
print("\nToken IDs:")
```

```
print(token_ids)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 6 — CREATE INPUT-TARGET PAIRS
```

```
# =====
```

```
# Example:
```

```
# input = i
```

```
# target = love
```

```
inputs = token_ids[:-1]
```

```
targets = token_ids[1:]
```

```
inputs = torch.tensor(inputs)
```

```
targets = torch.tensor(targets)
```

```
print("\nInputs:")
```

```
print(inputs)
```

```
print("\nTargets:")
```

```
print(targets)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 7 — MODEL HYPERPARAMETERS
```

```
# =====
```

```
vocab_size = len(vocab)
```

```
embedding_dim = 16
```

```
num_heads = 2
```

```
hidden_dim = 32
```



```
print("\nModel Configuration:")

print("Vocabulary Size:", vocab_size)

print("Embedding Dimension:", embedding_dim)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 8 — POSITIONAL ENCODING
```

```
# =====
```

```
class PositionalEncoding(nn.Module):

    def __init__(self, d_model, max_len=100):
```

```
        super().__init__()
```

```
        pe = torch.zeros(max_len, d_model)
```

```
        position = torch.arange(
            0,
            max_len
        ).unsqueeze(1)
```

```
        div_term = torch.exp(
            torch.arange(0, d_model, 2)
            * (-math.log(10000.0) / d_model)
        )
```

```
        pe[:, 0::2] = torch.sin(position * div_term)
```

```
pe[:, 1::2] = torch.cos(position * div_term)
```

```
self.pe = pe.unsqueeze(0)
```

```
def forward(self, x):
```

```
    seq_len = x.size(1)
```

```
    return x + self.pe[:, :seq_len]
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 9 — MINI TRANSFORMER MODEL
```

```
# =====
```

```
class MiniGPT(nn.Module):
```

```
    def __init__(self):
```

```
        super().__init__()
```

```
        # Embedding Layer
```

```
        self.embedding = nn.Embedding(
```

```
            vocab_size,
```

```
            embedding_dim
```

```
        )
```

```
        # Positional Encoding
```

```
        self.position = PositionalEncoding(
```

```

        embedding_dim
    )

    # Multi Head Attention
    self.attention = nn.MultiheadAttention(
        embed_dim=embedding_dim,
        num_heads=num_heads,
        batch_first=True
    )

    # Feed Forward Network
    self.ffn = nn.Sequential(

        nn.Linear(
            embedding_dim,
            hidden_dim
        ),

        nn.ReLU(),

        nn.Linear(
            hidden_dim,
            embedding_dim
        )
    )

    # Layer Normalization
    self.norm1 = nn.LayerNorm(
        embedding_dim

```

```
)
```

```
self.norm2 = nn.LayerNorm(
```

```
    embedding_dim
```

```
)
```

```
# Final Output Layer
```

```
self.fc = nn.Linear(
```

```
    embedding_dim,
```

```
    vocab_size
```

```
)
```

```
def forward(self, x):
```

```
    # Embedding
```

```
    x = self.embedding(x)
```

```
    # Add Positional Encoding
```

```
    x = self.position(x)
```

```
    # Self Attention
```

```
    attention_output, _ = self.attention(
```

```
        x,
```

```
        x,
```

```
        x
```

```
)
```

```
    # Residual + Normalize
```

```
    x = self.norm1(
```

```
        x + attention_output
    )
```

```
# Feed Forward
```

```
ffn_output = self.ffn(x)
```

```
# Residual + Normalize
```

```
x = self.norm2(
    x + ffn_output
)
```

```
# Final Vocabulary Prediction
```

```
output = self.fc(x)
```

```
return output
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 10 — CREATE MODEL
```

```
# =====
```

```
model = MiniGPT()
```

```
print("\nMini GPT Model Created Successfully")
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 11 — LOSS FUNCTION
```

```
# =====
```

```
loss_function = nn.CrossEntropyLoss()
```

```
print("\nLoss Function:")
```

```
print(loss_function)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 12 — OPTIMIZER
```

```
# =====
```

```
optimizer = optim.Adam(
```

```
    model.parameters(),
```

```
    lr=0.01
```

```
)
```

```
print("\nOptimizer:")
```

```
print(optimizer)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 13 — PREPARE INPUT SHAPE
```

```
# =====
```

```
# batch_size = 1
```

```
inputs = inputs.unsqueeze(0)
```

```
print("\nInput Shape:")
```

```
print(inputs.shape)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 14 — TRAINING LOOP
```

```
# =====
```

```
print("\nTraining Started...\n")
```

```
epochs = 200
```

```
for epoch in range(epochs):
```

```
    optimizer.zero_grad()
```

```
    # Forward Pass
```

```
    output = model(inputs)
```

```
    # Reshape Output
```

```
    output = output.view(
```

```
        -1,
```

```
        vocab_size
```

```
    )
```

```
    # Calculate Loss
```

```
    loss = loss_function(
```

```
        output,
```

```
        targets
```

```
    )
```

```
# Backpropagation
```

```
loss.backward()
```

```
# Update Weights
```

```
optimizer.step()
```

```
# Print Loss
```

```
if (epoch + 1) % 20 == 0:
```

```
    print(
```

```
        f"Epoch {epoch+1}, Loss: {loss.item():.4f}"
```

```
    )
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 15 — TEXT GENERATION
```

```
# =====
```

```
print("\nText Generation Started...\n")
```

```
model.eval()
```

```
# Start Word
```

```
current_word = "I"
```

```
generated_words = [current_word]
```

```
# Generate 5 words
```



```
for _ in range(5):
```

```
    # Convert Word → ID
```

```
    current_id = torch.tensor(
        [[word_to_idx[current_word]]]
    )
```

```
    # Model Prediction
```

```
    with torch.no_grad():
```

```
        output = model(current_id)
```

```
    # Get Highest Probability Word
```

```
    predicted_id = torch.argmax(
        output[0, -1]
    ).item()
```

```
    # Convert ID → Word
```

```
    predicted_word = idx_to_word[predicted_id]
```

```
    generated_words.append(
```

```
        predicted_word
    )
```

```
    current_word = predicted_word
```

```
# Final Sentence
```

```
generated_sentence = " ".join(
    generated_words
```

)

```
print("Generated Sentence:")
```

```
print(generated_sentence)
```

```
# =====
```

```
# STEP 16 — UNDERSTANDING THE FLOW
```

```
# =====
```

```
print("\n=====")
```

```
print("COMPLETE TRANSFORMER FLOW")
```

```
print("=====")
```

```
print("""
```

Text

↓

Tokenization

↓

Vocabulary IDs

↓

Embeddings

↓

Positional Encoding

↓

Self Attention

↓

Feed Forward Network

↓

Transformer Block



Prediction



Loss Calculation



Backpropagation



Weight Update



Text Generation

""")

## *PROJECTs TO PRACTICE :*

| <i>Project</i>                          | <i>What It Does</i>                            | <i>Main Skills Learned</i>                         |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <i>1. Next Word Predictor</i>           | <i>Predicts the next word from input text</i>  | <i>Tokenization, embeddings, softmax, training</i> |
| <i>2. Mini Chatbot</i>                  | <i>Simple conversational AI</i>                | <i>Text generation, attention, inference</i>       |
| <i>3. AI Text Summarizer</i>            | <i>Converts long text into short summaries</i> | <i>Encoder-decoder, sequence understanding</i>     |
| <i>4. &gt;PDFQuestion Answering Bot</i> | <i>Answers questions from uploaded PDFs</i>    | <i>RAG, embeddings, vector search</i>              |
| <i>5. ChatGPT Clone</i>                 | <i>AI assistant for chatting and answering</i> | <i>Transformers, fine-tuning, prompting</i>        |

*After Completing These :*

*1. Hugging face - Use real pretrained LLMs like GPT2, Llama*

*2. Fine-Tuning - Train AI on custom datasets*

*3. RAG (Retrieval Augmented Generation)*

*4. Vector Databases*

*5. LoRA / PEFT*

*6. AI Agents*

*7. Deployment*

**THANK YOU**